

All three exchanges are based in New York City, which today is the major financial hub in the United States and largest financial hub in the world. While there are other smaller stock exchanges, these three are where most buying and selling of stocks and other securities happens.

The U.S. exchanges have a wealth of history behind them and some date back many decades (e.g. the NASDAQ) and even a few centuries (e.g. the NYSE). If you are interested, [Investopedia.com](https://www.investopedia.com)² has a very interesting historical overview of the U.S. stock exchanges.

In Canada

The main stock exchange in Canada is the Toronto Stock Exchange, commonly referred to as the TSX and Canada's largest stock exchange. Other smaller exchanges include the TSX Venture Exchange (TSX-V) and the Canadian Securities Exchange (CSE),³ both of which focus on stock market trading for emerging companies.

Outside the United States or Canada

You can find a comprehensive list of global stock exchanges based on the country where you are located on [wikipedia.org](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_stock_exchanges) at https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_stock_exchanges.

INDICES AND THE STOCK MARKET

Now that you have a good sense of what the stock market is and about the stock exchanges where the actual trading happens, let's get into how stock market performance is measured.

Stock indices, also simply referred to as indices (or indexes), are also commonly mentioned when the stock market is discussed. Indices are made up of groups of stocks aggregated according to different industry sectors, a country's total stock market, or the global stock market. As defined by the Motley Fool:⁴